



Despondent about losing his brother and father – but mostly about losing all that gold – Regin moved to a nearby town. There he adopted Sigurd, the son of a king slain in battle. In time, Sigurd grew up to be a courageous, generous and courteous warrior.

One day, Regin told Sigurd about Fafnir and the hoard. “Imagine what great deeds we could do with all that treasure,” he said.

*“Make for me a sword sharp enough
and I will slay any dragon,” Sigurd replied.*

So Regin laboured over his forge, heating, hammering and dousing until he’d created a sword sharp enough to cut his own anvil in two.

“I shall call it Gram,” Sigurd said, giving it an experimental swish.

Regin took Sigurd to the hill where Fafnir lived.

“There, see how the great worm sits on all that treasure?”
the dwarf said, his eyes glinting.

Fafnir was huge – a scarlet, scaly, spiky dragon with a sinuous tail and serpentine neck. “I might be brave,” Sigurd gasped, “but I’m not stupid enough to fight that.”

As they watched, Fafnir crawled on his belly to a river and took a long drink of water.

